LEAN Data Governance DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

PURPOSE

Correct, consistent master data: owned by the business, enforced by technology, with AI agents doing the routine work.

SCOPE

Four domains, one per GPDO: Commercial, Manufacturing, Finance and Procurement.

SAP master data: governed in full.

Non-SAP and confidential data, such as recipes: owned and protected now.

THE PROBLEM

Incorrect: wrong or missing values break transactions and reports.

Inconsistent: duplicates, clashing conventions, systems that disagree.

Risks: trade secrets, payment fraud, privacy and audit.

GUIDING POLICY

Technology runs governance; people decide.

Lightweight policies, **E**mbedded controls, **A**gent-operated work and **N**amed ownership.

The app decides by default; people decide only what needs judgement.

THE TARGET SETUP

1. Own. GPDOs delegate parts to attribute owners, who set the rules in the app.

2. Enforce. The app checks and approves; AI agents prepare, chase and flag.

3. Run and assure. The data team runs it; internal controls checks the data team.

22 RULES

- One line each: what must be true
- 12 fix incorrect and inconsistent data
- 10 manage trade secret, fraud, privacy and audit risk
- 5 apply everywhere from the start

NEVER SWITCHED OFF

- Someone else confirms sensitive changes
- Payment data kept apart from paying
- Agents never approve, confirm or delete
- Trade secrets stay in controlled AI
- Every change traces to a request

MEASURES

- Share of requests the app approves alone
- People's decisions, and how long they take
- Records passing their checks
- Duplicates and system differences
- Changes without a request

Targets: [to set]

Who owns and decides DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

PRINCIPLE

Every piece of data has one named owner. A routine change needs one person, the requester; a sensitive change needs two.

WHO APPROVES WHAT

Charter: the four GPDOs and the platform owner

Rulebook, operating model, controls: the platform owner

Domain profiles: the GPDO the breakdown, attribute owners their part's settings

DATA OWNER: THE GPDO

- Accountable for the whole domain, in every system
- Approves the breakdown and who owns each part
- Sets the conventions across the domain
- Agrees shared data with the other GPDO
- Decides what's escalated

ATTRIBUTE OWNER

- Owns one part: a subdomain, business unit or group of fields
- Sets its rules as settings in the app
- Approves its exceptions and mass changes
- Decides who sees its classified data
- Decides what the app can't, or names delegates

DELEGATES

- At least two per part, from any team
- Confirm sensitive changes
- Decide likely duplicates
- Approve what the app can't, and review a monthly sample

Never settings, exceptions, mass changes or access. Whoever confirms payment data can't buy or pay.

PLATFORM OWNER

Held by the Head of Data, AI & Development [name]

- Accountable for the app, data platform, agents and data team
- Approves the rulebook, operating model and controls
- Decides nothing about data content

DATA TEAM

The platform owner's team

- Builds and runs the app, platform and agents
- Owns and supervises the agents
- Runs the owner review; keeps the documents current
- Provides the template, starters and training

INTERNAL CONTROLS

Held by the internal controls team [name]

- Reviews emergency access
- Reviews changes made without a request
- Samples the change reconciler's matches

The rules on one page DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

HOW THE RULES WORK

22 one-line rules in seven groups say what must be true; the controls say how. Each domain sets what good data looks like in its profile.

APPLY EVERYWHERE

Five rules cover all data from the start, SAP or not: **ownership**, **classified access**, **trade secrets** and **AI tools**. The rest cover SAP now, and other systems as they come in.

INCORRECT AND INCONSISTENT DATA

Ownership R-01, R-02	Every domain has a named owner, its GPDO, and every field exactly one owner.
Changing master data R-03 to R-08	One governed way in, and one system of record for each field. Requests are checked, then approved by the app or the owner; mass changes need sign-off; every change traces to a request.
Quality and third parties R-09 to R-12	Each domain sets its conventions, checks and thresholds. Issues are fixed at source, unused records are blocked, and third parties work within the rules.

TRADE SECRET, FRAUD, PRIVACY AND AUDIT RISK

Sensitive and payment data R-13 to R-15	Someone else confirms sensitive changes, payment data is kept apart from paying, and bank changes are verified with the supplier.
Trade secrets, privacy and access R-16, R-17, R-21	Classified fields, with access only where needed. Trade secrets are Restricted everywhere; personal data is blocked, then deleted.
Agents and AI R-18, R-22	Agents are registered, limited and logged. AI treats outside content as data, and outside models need approval.
Data team and exceptions R-19, R-20	The data team uses the governed process too. Exceptions are approved by the owner and time-limited.

Operating model: who does what DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

IN SHORT

GPDOs set up the domain, attribute owners set their parts, and delegates decide the daily cases. The data team runs the platform.

RHYTHM

- Decisions happen in the app, not in meetings
- Agents prompt owners and chase what's overdue
- Owner review: monthly at first, then quarterly
- Quarterly scorecard to the executive team

Activity	Covers	GPDO	Attribute owner	Data team	Platform owner	How often
Set up the domain	Breakdown, owners, conventions, shared data	A/R	C	C	I	On change
Set each part's rules	Settings and access; exceptions and mass changes	I	A/R	C	–	As needed
Decide daily cases	Sensitive changes, duplicates, what the app can't	–	A/R	–	–	Daily
Build and run the platform	App, data platform and agents; agent supervision	I	I	R	A	Ongoing
Keep the framework current	Rulebook, operating model and controls catalogue	C	C	R	A	On change

R responsible · **A** accountable · **C** consulted · **I** informed. Shaded: an attribute owner can hand this to delegates. Agents do much of the work but are never accountable.

MEASURES

Targets: [to set] after a month's baseline

- Requests the app approves alone
- People's decisions, and how long they take
- Time from request to use; first-time-right
- Records passing their checks
- Duplicates; SAP and non-SAP differences
- Downstream issues traced to master data
- Changes without an approved request
- Agents: work, acceptance and review time

Operating model: platform and agents DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

THE SPLIT

A check with a fixed answer belongs in the app. Coordination and routine work go to agents. Decisions stay with people.

AGENT GUARDRAILS

- Never approve, confirm, delete or grant access
- Start by proposing; a person decides
- Owners approve each move up a level
- A named owner in the data team; every action logged
- AI model approved first; trade secrets stay in controlled AI

UNIFIED MASTER DATA APP

- The front door for SAP master data
- Holds each domain's settings
- Checks every request on entry
- Approves what owners have approved
- Routes the rest; holds sensitive changes
- Records the request behind each change

SAP

- The system of record
- Changed only by the app, or by a domain's own process, such as engineering change
- Change documents record every change

DATA PLATFORM

- Checks stored data and builds the scorecards
- Compares non-SAP copies with SAP
- Finds changes without a request
- Holds the data agents read

AI AGENTS

Request assistant
For requesters
Pre-fills requests, explains failed checks and flags values that look wrong.

Owner assistant
For owners and delegates
Prepares each case and its evidence, and chases what's overdue.

Quality agent
For attribute owners
Finds duplicates and their causes, raises fixes and cleans up existing data.

Governance coordinator
For GPDOs and the platform owner
Prepares the owner review and scorecard; tracks decisions and exceptions.

Change reconciler
For internal controls
Matches SAP changes to the requests behind them, and reports any without.